

2-1 Sample Agenda and Guidance– Expectations Workshop

Objectives: (A subset of these can be selected based on project circumstances and familiarity with stakeholders)

- Clearly identify and document individual stakeholder expectations for the project
- Facilitate a shared understanding of the desired future state resulting from the project
- Systematically categorize stakeholder expectations based on different dimensions (e.g., process, tactical, strategic)
- Identify common ground and potential conflicts in expectations
- Define measurable success criteria
- Develop initial action items to address identified expectations and potential conflicts

Agenda Items:

- Welcome and introductions (The why)
- Project overview and context (The what) if known
- Individual expectation elicitation (The What Matters to You)
- “Imagine If...” (Brainstorm additional benefits the project can deliver)
- Developing an expectation management framework (Planning for ongoing alignment)
 - Discuss how stakeholder expectations will be managed, tracked, and communicated throughout the project
- Key success factors and critical risks (What will make or break us?)
- Prioritization and success criteria (Defining “done” together)
- Action Planning and next steps (Turning expectations into action)

Key Considerations for All Sessions:

- Preparation is crucial: Distribute pre-reading materials (project brief, initial objectives) to participants
- Provide neutral facilitation: As the experienced PM/BA, your role in guiding the discussions and ensuring everyone contributes is vital
- Engage active listening: Pay close attention to both verbal and non-verbal cues
- Documentation: Document all expectations, agreements, and action items clearly
- Be flexible: Be prepared to adapt the agenda based on the flow of the discussion and the participants’ needs